

Lesson 2 Thirteen Equals One



Listen then answer the question below.

Was the pastor pleased that the clock was striking? Why?

Our pastor is always raising money for one cause or another, but he has never managed to get enough money to have the church clock repaired. The big clock, which used to strike the hours day and night, was damaged many years ago and has been silent ever since.

- 5 One night, however, our pastor woke up with a start: the clock was striking the hours! Looking at his watch, he saw that it was one o'clock, but the bell struck thirteen times before it stopped. Armed with a flashlight, the pastor went up into the clock tower to see what was going on. In the beam of his flashlight, he caught sight of a figure who he immediately recognized as Bill Wilkins, our local grocer.

"Whatever are you doing up here, Bill?" asked the pastor in surprise.

"I'm trying to fix the bell," answered Bill. "I've been coming up here night after night for weeks now. You see, I was hoping to give you a surprise."

- 15 "You certainly did give me a surprise!" said the pastor. "You've probably woken up everyone in town as well. Still, I'm glad the bell is working again."

"That's the trouble, Pastor," answered Bill. "I've fixed it all right, but I'm afraid that at one o'clock it will strike thirteen times and there's nothing I can do about it."

"We'll get used to that, Bill," said the pastor. "Thirteen is not as good as one, but it's better than nothing. Now let's go downstairs and have a cup of tea."



New words and expressions

equal (title) /'i.kwəl/ *v.* to be the same as; to add up to

pastor /'pæs.tə/ *n.* a minister who leads a church

raise /reɪz/ *v.* to collect (money); to lift up

flashlight /'flæʃ.laɪt/ *n.* a handheld battery-powered light

Notes

- 1 **with a start** means **doing it suddenly** — like you've been jolted. "He woke up with a start" = he shot awake all at once, like something startled him.
- 2 **recognized ... as ...** When you "recognize someone as" a certain person, you look at them and realize exactly who they are. "He recognized the figure as Bill" basically means: he looked, and thought, "Oh — that's Bill."
- 3 **whatever** is not asking "which one" in here — it's used to show shock or disbelief, kind of like "what in the world" or "what on earth." "Whatever are you doing up here?" really just means "What are you doing up here?!" with extra punch.
- 4 **did** You don't usually need it in a line like "you gave me a surprise" because the words already make total sense on their own. Tossing "did" in there—"you certainly did give me a surprise"—just leans into the feeling and makes it hit harder, like saying: "Man, you really did surprise me!"
- 5 **not as good as** This is just the classic "as ___ as" comparison, flipped negative. "Thirteen is not as good as one" means one is better than thirteen — the first thing doesn't measure up to the second.

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Summary Writing

Describe what happened from the moment the pastor woke up *in 80 words or less*. Do not include anything that is not in the passage.

Answer these questions in note form to get your points:

- | | |
|--|--|
| 1 What woke the pastor up? | 7 Who did he see in the clock tower? |
| 2 What time was it? | 8 What did Bill Wilkins say he was trying to do? |
| 3 How many times did the clock strike? | 9 Had Bill Wilkins succeeded in fixing the clock or not? |
| 4 Where did the pastor go? | 10 Was the pastor pleased or angry? |
| 5 What did he take with him? | 11 What did he offer the grocer? |
| 6 What did he see in the clock tower? | |

Vocabulary

Give another word or phrase you could use instead of each of these, as they're used in the passage: pastor; repaired; damaged; silent; with a start; caught sight of.

Composition

Write a composition of about 200 words using the ideas below:

Title: A Sticky Business

Introduction: A small town — the church clock suddenly stopped — no one could explain why.

Development: The pastor climbed into the clock tower — found that the clock had been invaded by bees — full of honey and wax.

Conclusion: A beekeeper was called — removed the queen bee — the other bees followed — the clock was cleaned — working again.

Letter writing

Write six phrases you could use to begin a letter to a friend.

Key structures

What's happening? What always happens?

With the word always, we can sometimes use the "-ing" form of the verb (present progressive) instead of the simple present. This usually adds a little extra feeling to it — like the habit is constant, maybe even a bit much:

Our pastor is always raising money.

He's always getting into trouble.

She's always writing letters.

Exercise

Underline the verbs in the passage that show what's happening right now, and take note of how they're used.

Special difficulties

These little "in + noun" phrases are idioms — you can't always guess the meaning just from the words, so they're worth learning as whole chunks.

Study these examples:

"Whatever are you doing up here, Bill?" asked the pastor in surprise.

Please write *in ink*, not *in pencil*.

We have a great deal *in common*.

The swimmer seemed to be *in trouble*, but he managed to reach the shore in the end.

I didn't feel well, so I spent the day *in bed*.

We have received fifty applications *in all*.

The thieves were disturbed and left *in a hurry*.

I can't borrow any more money; I'm already *in debt*.

Mary's *in love* with a sailor.

There wasn't a person *in sight*.

He didn't realize that he *was in danger*.

The little boy *was in tears*.

Exercises

Use a phrase with *in* in place of the words in italics.

- 1 I left home very quickly so as not to miss the train.
- 2 I suppose I will finish this eventually.
- 3 In the early morning, there was not a person to be seen.
- 4 Should I write with a pen or with a pencil?
- 5 They don't have many interests which they share.
- 6 Why is that little girl crying?

Multiple choice questions

Choose the correct answers to the following questions.

Comprehension

- 1 The church clock didn't work because _____.
 - (a) the church had never raised enough money to fix it
 - (b) it kept the pastor awake at night
 - (c) Bill Wilkins was too busy to fix it
 - (d) no one in town knew how to repair it
- 2 The pastor was surprised to find Bill Wilkins in the clock tower because _____.
 - (a) Bill had been hoping to surprise him
 - (b) it was an unusual time and place to find him

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(c) he'd never met Bill Wilkins before

(d) the clock had struck thirteen times

3 The pastor offered Bill Wilkins a cup of tea because _____.

(a) he thought that Bill Wilkins was thirsty

(b) thanks to Bill, the clock would now strike once an hour

(c) he was grateful for the trouble Bill Wilkins had taken

(d) he was pleased to have been woken up for nothing

Structure

4 In the past, the big clock _____ the hours, day and night.

(a) struck always

(b) always struck

(c) was always striking

(d) has always been striking

5 It was not until the thirteenth stroke _____ the bell stopped.

(a) before

(b) when

(c) so that

(d) that

6 The pastor asked Bill _____ doing up in the church tower.

(a) what was he

(b) what he was

(c) what he is

(d) whatever was he

7 "I _____ it all right, but I'm afraid..."

(a) will fix

(b) am fixing

(c) have fixed

(d) fixed

8 "We'll get used to _____ that, Bill."

(a) hearing

(b) hear

(c) the sound

(d) having heard

Vocabulary

9 Money that's collected for a cause is called _____.

(a) cash

(b) a fund

(c) a scholarship

(d) an investment

10 A grocer is someone who _____.

(a) runs a store

(b) eats a lot

(c) sells bread

(d) surprises people

11 "I've been coming here _____ for weeks now."

(a) every night

(b) all night

(c) the following night

(d) several nights

12 "_____, I'm glad the bell's working again."

(a) Yet

(b) Good

(c) Just the same

(d) Even now

Answer Key

1 a ·

4 b ·

9 b ·

2 b ·

5 d ·

10 a ·

3 c ·

6 b ·

11 a ·

7 c ·

12 c

8 a ·